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REFERENCES

Professor Daniel Sturm
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EDUCATION

London School of Economics and Political Science
PhD in Economics

London, UK
2026 (expected)

London School of Economics and Political Science
MRes in Economics, *distinction*

London, UK
2021

PUC-Rio
MSc in Economics

Rio de Janeiro, Brazil
2019

Universidade de São Paulo
BA in Economics

São Paulo, Brazil
2016

RESEARCH FIELDS

Main: Urban, Labor
Secondary: Trade, Development

JOB MARKET PAPER

Home Production in the City

By 2050, two thirds of the world's population is predicted to live in cities, predominantly mega-cities. Agglomeration drives up productivity, but the commuting costs may act as a brake by incentivizing specialization within the household, and thus potentially halving labor force participation. Using origin-destination travel data from the mega city of Sao Paulo in Brazil, I document that labor force participation declines sharply with distance from the city center, a spatial gradient largely driven by married women. When women work, they not only face lower wages, but also commute in slower modes of transport, relying more often on public transport and less on driving than men. To quantify the implications of these patterns for productivity, I model the trade-off between benefits of agglomeration and the cost of commuting using a quantitative spatial framework in which couples and singles decide where to live and whether and where to work. My model reveals that if women had the same access to private cars as men, labor force participation would increase by 11.5 percentage points—an effect larger than equalizing labor market returns by gender—with especially strong impacts for married women on the urban periphery. This shows that investing in transportation infrastructure that makes commuting equal by gender would draw many women into the labor market, potentially halving the gender gap in labor supply.

PUBLICATION

Monitoring Technology: The Impact of Body-Worn Cameras on Citizen-Police Interactions

with Daniel A.C. Barbosa, Thiemo Fetzer, and Pedro C.L. Souza.

Review of Economics and Statistics, 2025.

We provide experimental evidence that using body-worn cameras (BWCs) for police monitoring improves police-citizen interactions. In an intervention carried in Brazil in 2018, we find that treated dispatches show a 61.2% decrease in police use of force and a 47.0% reduction in adverse interactions, including handcuff use and arrests. The use of body-worn cameras also improve the quality of officers' record from the dispatches. The rate of incomplete reports dropped by 5.9%, which is accompanied by a 69% increase in the notification of domestic violence. We explore various mechanisms that explain why BWCs work and show that the results are consistent with the police changing their behavior in the presence of cameras. Overall, results show that the use of body-worn cameras de-escalates conflicts.

WORK IN PROGRESS

The Geography of Life: Evidence from Copenhagen

with Gabriel Ahlfeldt, Ismir Mulalic, and Daniel Sturm.

We use newly constructed individual-level panel data for Denmark covering more than 30 years to document and understand the origins and consequences of spatial sorting by age and family status within cities. Based on by reduced-form evidence that disentangles sorting by age and family status from correlated individual effects, we develop a quantitative urban model with heterogeneity by skill, age, and family status. We use the quantified model to show that the main mechanism driving spatial sorting is heterogeneity in preferences for local amenities. Finally, we use the estimated model to explore the effect of demographic change — population aging, falling fertility, and increasing singlehood — on cities and find that their combined effect on cities will be substantially more muted than any of these changes on their own.

Land Value Capture and Air Rights: Evidence from São Paulo

with Gharad Bryan, Flavia Leite, and Nick Tsivanidis.

BOOK CHAPTER

Can Trust Be Built through Citizen Monitoring of Police Activity? Evidence from Santa Catarina, Brazil

with Daniel A.C. Barbosa, Thiemo Fetzer, and Pedro C.L. Souza.

Cambridge University Press, 2024.

This chapter studies the effect of Rede de Vizinhos (RdV or “Neighbor Network”) community policing program in Santa Catarina, Brazil, which aims to improve public safety and trust between citizens and police by facilitating real time information about crime and public safety through dedicated WhatsApp instant messages groups with the participation of a police officer. We randomly allocated neighborhoods that would see the policy implemented into treatment and control groups, with the former being exposed to an information campaign through which we publicized induction meetings using Facebook. Despite reaching roughly 10 percent of Santa Catarina’s population, our study does not find a differential participation rate in the RdV campaign regions. Further, we don’t find evidence of increased perceptions over the police or improvements over criminal rates in treated neighborhoods. Our results suggest that despite their promise, (technology-enabled) community policing programs may fail to deliver substantial impacts given saturation dynamics and diminishing marginal returns – our baseline surveys indicated that 52 percent of respondents had heard already about the RdV program with 13.1 percent actively participating.

SCHOLARSHIPS, GRANTS AND AWARDS

Class Teacher Award: 2023 (highly commended), 2024

Excellence in Education Award: 2023, 2024

STEG PhD grant (£15,000), 2024

STICERD PhD grant (£5,000), 2023

Hub for Equal Representation (H.E.R.) grant (£5,000), 2023

IGC Small Research Grant (£13,800) with G. Bryan, F. Leite and N. Tsivanidis, 2023

PhD Fellowship (LSE Department of Economics, London, UK), 2019

PUC-Rio fellowship, 2017-2019

CNPQ scholarship, 2017-2019

EXTERNAL PRESENTATIONS

2025: EMUEA, Barcelona Summer Forum, NBER Summer Institute

2023: International Conference of Development Economics (ICDE)

2021: RIDGE-LACEA (Virtual)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research assistant for Prof. O. Bandiera, 2020

Research assistant for Prof. P. Souza and T. Fetzer, 2018

Research assistant for Prof. N. Menezes-Filho, 2014-2016

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Fellow, Microeconomics for Public Policy, MPA, LSE, 2022-2024

Teaching Fellow, Empirical Methods for Public Policy, EMPA/EMPP, LSE, 2020-2024

Teaching Fellow, Introduction to Statistics, EMPA/EMPP, LSE, 2020-2025

Teaching Fellow, Applied Micro in R, EMAP, QMUL, 2022 – 2023

Teaching Assistant, Microeconomics I (EC1A3), LSE, 2021-2023

Teaching Assistant, Macroeconomics I (EC1B1), LSE, 2021-2023

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Referee for *Journal of Urban Economics*; *Regional Science and Urban Economics*

CEP International Workshop Organizer, 2022-2024

LANGUAGES AND SKILLS

Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (fluent), Dutch (basic)

Stata, R, Matlab, Latex

Last updated: September, 2025